

हिंदी

Hindi phrasebook

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Changes made for Hindi Learn!: the pictures, the links and the section “Learning more” left out; laid out as a PDF. This PDF is under CC BY-SA 4.0 too: you may share and adapt it, crediting Wikivoyage, under the same licence.

Hindi phrasebook

Hindi (हिन्दी) is an Indo-Aryan language spoken in India, Nepal, and throughout the Indian diaspora in Fiji, Singapore, Uganda, the United Arab Emirates, Trinidad, Suriname, Guyana, South Africa, the UK, the US, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, Mauritius and other countries. Where there are 22 official languages and over 1,000 dialects of India, Hindi and English take precedence in government affairs. It is a link-language for over half of India's population. It is also one of the 3 official languages of Fiji.

Hindi is descended from Sanskrit, sometimes called "the mother of all languages," or "Latin of the East." Standard Hindi is based on the खड़ी बोली Kharī Bolī dialect (lit. "Pure language"). A mixture of Hindi and Urdu, called **Hindustani** (though this name is also applied to the Caribbean dialect of Hindi), is the form heard in most Bollywood films, trying to appeal to the widest audience possible. Hindustani is different from what is taught at the literary level and what is used by news programs and the government in India.

As per the 2011 census, Hindi is the fastest growing language in India, followed by Kashmiri, Meitei (Manipuri), Gujarati, and Bengali.

A striking fact is that, depending on the source, Hindi is listed anywhere from the 2nd to 5th most widely spoken language in the world. In contrast to languages such as Mandarin or Spanish, there has not been much promotion of learning Hindi as a second language outside of India and some neighbouring South Asian countries such as Bhutan.

Writing

Hindi is written in the **Devanāgarī** (देवनागरी) script, like Nepali, Marathi and a number of other Indian languages. Learning Devanagari is not quite as difficult as you might think at first glance, but mastering it takes a while and is beyond the scope of most travellers. See **Learning Devanagari** for a primer. Hindi is also commonly written in the Latin alphabet in online settings.

Pronunciation

Most English speakers find Hindi pronunciation rather challenging, as there are 11 separate vowels and 35 separate consonants, employing a

large number of distinctions not found in English. **Don't let this intimidate you:** Many speakers do not speak standard Hindi in practice but rather in regional accents which don't use as many consonants and/or vowels.

Vowels

The key distinction is the difference between **short** and **long** vowels. In this phrasebook, long vowels are noted with a digraph (two letters), whereas short vowels are listed as one letter.

Devana-gari	Pseudo-phoneticisation	Equivalent/Comments
अ	uh	as in about
आ	ah	as in father
इ	ih	as in sit
ई	ee	as in elite
उ	u	as in put
ऊ	oo	as in moon
ऋ	rih	as in trip or Scottish heard (this form is rarely used in Hindi)
ए	eh	long e . It is not a diphthong; the tone does <i>not</i> fall.
ऐ	ay	as in fair , sometimes a longer ए, in Eastern dialects as in bright
ओ	oh	not a diphthong; tone does <i>not</i> fall.
औ	aw	as in caught , in Eastern dialects as in town
ऑ	o	as in not

Common diphthongs

Devanagari	Pseudo-phoneticisation	Equivalent/Comments
अइ/अई/अय	igh	as in bright
आइ/आई/आय	īgh	same as above, but longer
अउ/अऊ/अव	ow	as in loud

आउ/आऊ/आव	ōw	same as above, but longer
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Consonants

Hindi consonants have many qualities not familiar to native English speakers including **aspiration** and **retroflex** consonants.

Aspiration means "with a puff of air", and is the difference between the sound of the letter "k" in English *kin* (aspirated) and *skip* (unaspirated). In this phrasebook, aspirated sounds are spelled with an h (so English "kin" would be *khin*) and unaspirated sounds without it (so "skip" is still *skip*). Hindi aspiration is quite forceful and it's OK to emphasize the puff.

Hindi retroflex consonants, on the other hand, are not really found in English. They should be pronounced with the tongue tip curled back. Practice with a native speaker, or just pronounce as usual — you'll usually still get the message across.

Devanagari	Pseudo-phoneticisation	Equivalent/Comments
क	k (beginning of syllable) ck (end of syllable)	as in <i>skip</i> .
ख	kh	as in <i>sinkhole</i> .
ग	g	as in <i>go</i> .
घ	gh	as in <i>doghouse</i> .
ङ	ng	as in <i>sing</i> . Used only in Sanskrit loanwords, does not occur independently.
च	ch	as in <i>church</i> .
छ	chh	as in <i>pinchhit</i> .
ज	j	as in <i>jump</i> .
झ	jh	as in <i>dodge her</i> .
ञ	ny	as in <i>canyon</i> . Used only in Sanskrit loan words, does not occur independently.
ट	tt	as in <i>tick</i> . Retroflex, but still a "hard" t sound similar to English.

ठ	tth	as in ligh th ouse. Retroflex
ड	dd	as in d oom. Retroflex
ढ	ddh	as in mud h ut. Retroflex
ण	nn	retroflex n . Used only in Sanskrit loanwords.
त	t	does not exist in English. more dental t , with a bit of a th sound. Softer than an English t .
थ	th	aspirated version of the previous letter, <i>not</i> as in th anks or th e.
द	d	dental d .
ध	dh	aspirated version of the above.
न	n	dental n .
प	p	as in p in.
फ	ph	as in u'ph' ill.
ब	b	as in b e.
भ	bh	as in ab hor.
म	m	as in m ere.
य	y	as in y et.
र	r	as in Spanish p ero, a tongue trip. Don't roll as in Spanish rr , German or Scottish English.
ल	l	as in l ean.
व	v/w	as in Spanish v aca, between English v and w , but without the lip rounding of an English w . (IPA: ʋ).
श	sh	as in sh oot.
ष	ssh	almost indistinguishable retroflex of the above. Used only in Sanskrit loanwords.
स	s (beginning of syllable) ss (end of syllable)	as in s ee.
ह	h	as in h im.

Nuqta

Besides vowel diacritics, Hindi also has a special diacritic for consonants, called *nuqta* (नुक्ता *nooq-tah*). It is used to alter the pronunciation of consonants to render loanwords.

क़ q

like **skip** but further back in the throat (IPA: q)

ख़ kh

like **Chanukkah** or Scottish **loch** (IPA: x)

ग़ gh

like Dutch **geen** (IPA: ɣ)

ज़ z

like **zoo** (IPA: z)

झ़ zh

like **measur**e (IPA: ʒ)

फ़ f

like **fin** (IPA: f)

Stress

For emphasising words don't stress them by voice (which would be regarded as a sign of aggressiveness) but add a *to* after them.

yuhh kyah hay? ("what's this?") → *yuhh toh kyah hay?* - ("what is **this?**")

Voice should always be very low and with few changes in pitch, loudness and stress, so please: *relax!*

One of the only stresses found in Hindi is the last long syllable prior to the last syllable (e.g. in "dhuh-nyuh-vahd" stress "dhuh"). But it is a mild stress which occurs naturally, so don't force it. Don't even think about it!

शुभकामनाएँ! (*shoobh-kahm-nah-ēh!*) — Good luck

Grammar

Pronouns	Singular	Plural
1st Person	मैं (<i>may</i>) (I)	हम (<i>huhm</i>) (We)
2nd Person (intimate)	तू (<i>tōo</i>) (You)	-
2nd Person (familiar)	तुम (<i>toom</i>) (You)	तुम (<i>toom</i>) (You)
2nd Person (honorary)	आप (<i>aap</i>) (You)	आप (<i>aap</i>) (You)

3rd Person Proximal (familiar)	यह (<i>yuhh</i>) (This/He/She/It)	ये (<i>yeh</i>) (These/He/She/It)
3rd Person Proximal (honorary)	ये (<i>yeh</i>) (He/She)	ये (<i>yeh</i>) (He/She)
3rd Person Distal (familiar)	वह (<i>vuhh</i>) (That/He/She/It)	वे (<i>veh</i>) (Those/He/She/It)
3rd Person Distal (honorary)	वो (<i>voh</i>) (That/He/She/It)	वो (<i>voh</i>) (They/These)

Gender & The 2nd Person Pronoun: Certain words have different endings depending on your gender. If you are a man, say these with an -आ suffix, and if you're a woman, -ई. However; when addressing the person respectively with *ahp* (आप), the masculine ending takes the plural form. This is not all that different from the behavior of other Indo-European languages, c.f. German *Sie*, which like *ahp* is also both the respectful 2nd person pronoun *and* plural form of address. The other two forms are the familiar *toom* (तुम) and intimate *tōo* (तू). These change the forms of certain words. *Toom* is for friends and peers, *tōo* for small children (within the family); between 'significant others' in private; traditionally to lower castes; in the past, slaves; and, paradoxically, when supplicating to the gods/God (c.f. Greek mythology). As a general rule, stick with *ahp*, until you become more familiar with the language and culture. Forget about *tōo* altogether, at the best using it would be a *faux pas* and at the worst, very offensive. For those reasons as well as practical ones, this section will only use the *ahp* form.

Grammatical Gender: Like many major European languages, but not English, Hindi nouns have a grammatical gender assigned to them. There are two genders in Hindi, masculine and feminine, and even inanimate objects have a gender.

Hindi Phrases

Cultural notes

Greetings: There are no time elemental greetings in conversational Hindi such as good morning, good afternoon, etc. And each religion has its own greetings. It is considered very gracious to address a person by *their* respective greetings, but not necessary.

Namaste (नमस्ते *nuh-muhss-teh*) is the most ubiquitous greeting. Though of Hindu origin it is now mostly secular. You say *namaste* with your hands folded and by bowing slightly – but don't go overboard Japanese

style! *Namaste* literally means "I bow to you." The original religious significance was of bowing to the soul (*aht-mah*) within another. It is custom to touch the feet of someone older than you when saying *namaste*. *Namaskār* (नमस्कार *nuh-muhss-kahr*) has the same meaning, but is used less often in Hindi, though it is common in other Indian languages such as Gujarati and Bengali. *Namaskār* is thought of as more formal, and as such is used more often when addressing a group or a person of importance. The Sikhs also fold their hands and bow, but have their own greetings. *Sat śrī akāl* (ਸਤ ਸ਼੍ਰੀ ਅਕਾਲ *suht shree uh-kahl*) is the most common, which comes from the Punjabi ਸਤਿ ਸ੍ਰੀ ਅਕਾਲ meaning "God alone is Truth." Though Sikh people are mostly found in the Punjab region of India, Punjabi greetings are used by Sikhs all over the world. After meeting someone for the first time आपसे मिलकर बहुत खुशी हुई (*ahp-seh mil-kuhr buh-hoot khoo-shee hoo-ee*) may be said, meaning "I'm very happy to meet you."

Civilities: In Western cultures, phrases like *please*, *thank you*, *you're welcome*, *excuse me*, *sorry*, etc. are so ingrained into the people from a young age that they say them without a second thought. Not so for Indians. Saying such phrases in an inappropriate circumstance might even embarrass the person, or cheapen the gravity of the phrase itself. These phrases are only said in a sincere sense. For example, don't say धन्यवाद (*dhuh-nyuh-vahd*, thank you) after a clerk hands you your grocery bag, but when someone goes out of their way to do something nice for you. Sometimes, English words themselves are used; due to the British colonial influence, especially in urban areas and among the upper class. In this case, use them as you would in English.

When someone is in your way, instead of saying *excuse me*, or *zara suniye*, just let out an aspirated *ts* sound with your tongue behind your teeth to attract their attention. This might seem rude, but is no more rude than children saying "pssst" to get a friend's attention during class! In conclusion, though Hindi has corresponding words to ours, this does not mean that the context in which they are used also corresponds accordingly. Don't let all of this lead you to believe Indians are cold though – nothing could be further from the truth! These sentiments are merely communicated through body language rather than verbally. To show your thanks, a simple smile will do the trick. Other common gestures include the famous "head bobble"; and a hand gesture made by swiftly swinging the wrist so your palm is facing the sky and your forefingers slightly elongated. Before travelling to India, rent some

Bollywood films so that if a spontaneous Bhangra breaks out in the streets, you'll be ready to join in! All kidding aside, they can demonstrate body language and customs far better than any book is able to, all while acclimatizing you to the language as well.

Prefixes & Suffixes: When you answer with the words "yes" and "no", the word *jī* (जी *jee*) may be added afterwards to give it a more polite tone. Sometimes, speakers will simply reply with *jī*, as an affirmation of something someone says. *Jī* is added to a person's name as a sign of respect. For example; in India, Mahatma Gandhi is often referred to as *Gandhiji* (गांधीजी).

Another suffix which is indispensable is *-wallah* (-वाला *-vah-lah*). Many books devote whole chapters to *-wallah*. With nouns, it gives the meaning "the one or thing that does" and with verbs, it indicates something is about to happen. Examples:

- noun – shop (दुकान *doo-kahn*) + (-वाला *wah-lah*) = shopkeeper (दुकानवाला *doo-kahn-wah-lah*)
- verb – to come (आना *ah-nah*) + (-वाला *wah-lah*) = (the) ... is coming (... आनेवाला है ... *ah-neh-wah-lah hay*)

English loanwords: The British Empire's influence spread into the language itself, and this continues today with American culture being exported throughout the world. So, an English word or phrase may almost always be inserted into any Hindi sentence. You will often hear Indians, whom while talking in Hindi, pepper their sentences with English words. Sometimes, they'll even alternate sentences, going from Hindi to English, and back to Hindi! The local urbanites call it *Hinglish*, a mixture of the two languages. English loanwords are particularly used for modern inventions/technologies, so words like TV, computer and microwave are the same as in English apart from the slight change of accent. However; this is mostly in the cities, and learning some Hindi will be all the more rewarding when in rural or non-tourist areas, as well as allowing you to communicate with a wider variety of people in the cities.

Basics

Common signs

OPEN
CLOSED
ENTRANCE
EXIT
PUSH
PULL
TOILET
MEN
WOMEN
FORBIDDEN

मना है (*muh-nuh hay*)

Accha! OK? TK!

One of the most useful words to know is *accha* (अच्छा *uhch-chha*). It is both an adjective and interjection. Its meanings include (but are not limited to!): good, excellent, healthy, well, OK, really?, awesome!, hmm..., a-ha!, etc.! If you learn no other word, remember this one.

Another common all-purpose word is *thīk hai* (ठीक है *ttheeck hay*), pronounced and occasionally even spelled out as "TK". It is used in the same manner, meaning: OK/ all right, yes/understood (affirmation), right/correct, etc. Sometimes shortened to just *thīk*.

English	Hindi	Pseudo-phoneticisation
Hello (when answering the phone)	हेलो	heh-loh
Hello	नमस्ते	nuh-muhss-teh
Hello/Goodbye	नमस्कार	nuh-muhss-kahr
Hello/Goodbye (Hindu, respectful)	प्रणाम	pruh-nnahm
Hello/Goodbye (Hindu, colloquial)	राम राम	rahm rahm
Hello/Goodbye (Sikh)	ਸਤ ਸ਼੍ਰੀ ਅਕਾਲ	suht shree uh-kahl
Hello/Goodbye (Sikh, formal)	ਵਾਹਿਗੁਰੂ ਜੀ ਕਾ ਖਾਲਸਾ	vah-hih-goo-rōo jee kah khalss
Hello/Goodbye (Sikh, reply)	ਵਾਹਿਗੁਰੂ ਜੀ ਕੀ ਫ਼ਤਹ	vah-hih-goo-rōo jee kee fuh-tuh
See you later	फिर मिलेंगे	phir mih-lehng-geh

How are you?	आप कैसे/कैसी हैं?	ahp kay-seh/kay-see hay? (masc./fem.)
How are you?	आप ख़ैरियत से हैं?	ahp khay-rih-yuht seh hay?
I am fine	मैं ठीक हूँ	may tttheeck hōo
OK/fine (colloq.)	ठीक है	tttheeck hay
Fine, and you? (more formal reply)	ठीक, आप सुनाइये	tttheeck, ahp soo-naih-yeh
What is your name?	आपका नाम क्या है?	ahp-kah nahm kyah hay?
My name is ____ .	मेरा नाम ____ है।	meh-rah nahm ____ hay.
Nice to meet you (formal).	आपसे मिलकर बहुत ख़ूशी हुई।	ahp-seh mihl-kuhr buh-hoot khōo-shee hoo-ee
Nice to meet you too (reply).	मुझे भी	moo-jheh bhee
Yes	हाँ	hah
No/not	नहीं	nuh-hih
Do you speak English?	आपको अंग्रेज़ी आती है?	ahp-koh uhng-greh-zih ah-tee hay?
Is there someone here who speaks English?	क्या किसी को अंग्रेज़ी आती है?	kyah kih-see koh uhng-greh-zih ah-tee hay?
I don't speak Hindi.	मुझे हिन्दी नहीं आती है।	moo-jheh hihn-dee nuh-hee ah- tee hay.
I can't speak Hindi	मैं हिन्दी नहीं बोल सकता हूँ।	maih hihn-dee nuh-hee bohl suhck-tah hōo.
I speak some Hindi.	मुझे कुछ हिन्दी आती है।	moo-jheh koochh hihn-dee ah- tee hay.
I don't understand.	मैं समझा/समझी नहीं।	maih suhm-jhah/suhm-jhee nuh- hee (masc./fem.)
Speak more slowly	धीरे धीरे बोलिये	dhee-reh dhee-reh boh-lih-yeh
Come again?	फिरसे?	phihr-seh?

What does "... " mean?	"..." का मतलब क्या है?	"..." kah muht-luhb kyuh hay?
How do you say "... "?	"..." कैसे कहते हैं?	"..." kay-seh kuh-huh-teh hay?
Where are you from?	आप कहाँ से हैं?	ahp kuh-hah seh hay?
I'm from ...	मैं ... से हूँ	may ... seh hōo
Please	कृपया	krihp-yah
Thank you	धन्यवाद / शुक्रिया / थैंक्यू	dhuhn-yuh-vahd/shooock-rih-yah / thayng-kyōo
Thank you very much	बहुत बहुत शुक्रिया,...	buh-hoot buh-hoot thayng-kyōo,...
You're welcome	आपका स्वागत है	ahp-kah swah-guht hay
You're welcome (lit. don't mention it)	कोई बात नहीं	koh-ee baht nuh-hee
Excuse me (getting someone's attention)	सुनिये	soo-nih-yeh
Pardon me	क्षमा कीजिये	(k)sshuh-mah kee-jih-yeh
Pardon me/I'm sorry	माफ़ कीजिये	mahf kee-jih-yeh
Where is the toilet?	टॉयलेट / शौचालय कहाँ है?	ttoy-lehtt / shaw-chah-lay kuh-hah hay?
Good!, really?, nice, etc.	अच्छा	uhch-chhah
Just one minute	एक मिनट	ehk mih-nuhtt
What time is it?	कितने बजे हैं?	kiht-neh buh-jeh hay?

Forms of Address

English	Hindi	Transliteration
Mr.	मिस्टर / श्री	mihss-ttuhr / shree
Mrs.	मिसेज़ / श्रीमती	mih-sehz / shree-muh-tee
Mr. (Sikh: ਸਰਦਾਰ)	सरदार	suhr-dahr
Mrs. (Sikh: ਸਰਦਾਰਨੀ)	सरदारनी	suhr-dahr-nee
Sir	महोदय	muh-hoh-day

Dr.	डॉक्टर	ddock-ttuhr
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Interrogatives

English	Hindi	Transliteration
how/of what kind?	कैसा?	kaisa
how much/many?	कितना/कितने?	kitna/kitne
what?	क्या?	kyā?
when?	कब?	kab?
where?	कहाँ?	kahā?
who?	कौन?	kaun?
which?	कौनसा?	kaunsa?
why?	क्यों?	kyo?

Numbers

The numerals used to write in decimal are called Indo-Arabic numerals. Developed in India, they were borrowed by the Arabs, and gradually spread to Europe. The similarities are hard to miss. Here are their respective numerals.

Indo-Arabic	Devanagari
0	०
1	१
2	२
3	३
4	४
5	५
6	६
7	७
8	८
9	९

Hindi numbers ending in 9 are named as "un" (-1) plus the next multiple of ten. Instead of naming powers of a thousand, Hindi has unique names for a thousand, a hundred thousand, ten million etc.

Nu me ral	Hi n di	Transl iterati on	Nu me ral	Hi n di	Transl iterati on	Nu me ral	Hi n di	Transl iterati on	Nu me ral	Hi n di	Transl iterati on
0	शू न्य	shUny a, bi.ndi	25	प च्ची स	paccīs	50	प चा स	pacās	75	प च ह तर	pachat tar
1	ए क	ek	26	छ ब्बी स	chabbī s	51	इ क्या वन	ikyāva n	76	छि ह तर	chihatt ar
2	दो	do	27	स ताई स	sataīs	52	बा वन	bāvan	77	स तह तर	sathatt ar
3	ती न	tīn	28	अ ट्टाई स	aṭṭhāīs	53	ति रप न	tirpan	78	अ ठह तर	aṭṭhat tar
4	चा र	chār	29	उन ती स	untīs	54	चौ वन	cauva n	79	उ न्या सी	unyāsī
5	पां च	pānc	30	ती स	tīs	55	प च पन	pacpa n	80	अ स्सी	assī
6	छ ह, छै, छः	chēh, chai, cheḥ	31	इक ती स	ikttīs	56	छ प्प न	chapp an	81	इ क्या सी	ikyāsī
7	सा त	sāt	32	बत्ती स	battīs	57	स त्ता वन	sattāv an	82	ब या सी	bayāsī

8	आ ठ	āṭh	33	तैंती स	taintīs	58	अ ड्डा वन	aṭṭhāv an	83	ति रा सी	tirāsī
9	नौ	nau	34	चौं ती स	cauntīs	59	उन स ठ	unsaṭh	84	चौ रा सी	caurās ī
10	द स	das	35	पैंती स	paintīs	60	सा ठ	sāṭh	85	प चा सी	pacāsī
11	ग्या रह	gyāreh	36	छ ती स	chattīs	61	इ क स ठ	iksaṭh	86	छि या सी	chiyāsī
12	बा रह	bareh	37	सैं ती स	saintīs	62	बा स ठ	bāsaṭh	87	सा ता सी	sattāsī
13	तेर ह	tereh	38	अड़ ती स	aṛtīs	63	ति रस ठ	tirsaṭh	88	अ ड्डा सी	aṭṭhāsī
14	चौ द ह	caude h	39	उन ता ली स	untālīs	64	चौं स ठ	cainsa ṭh	89	न वा सी	navāsī
15	पं द्र ह	pandr eh	40	चा ली स	cālīs	65	पैं स ठ	painsa ṭh	90	न ब्बे	nabbe
16	सो ल ह	soleh	41	इक ता ली स	iktālīs	66	छि या स ठ	chiyās aṭh	91	इ क्या नवे	ikyāna ve
17	स त्र ह	satreh	42	बया ली स	bayālīs	67	सर स ठ	sarsaṭ h	92	बा ना वे	bānav e

18	अ ठा रह	aṭhāre h	43	तैंता ली स	taintālī s	68	अ ड़ स ठ	aṛsaṭh	93	ति रा नवे	tirānav e
19	उ नी स	unnīs	44	चवा ली स	cavālīs	69	उन त हर	unhatt ar	94	चौ रा नवे	caurān ave
20	बी स	bīs	45	पैंता ली स	paintālī s	70	स तर	sattar	95	प चा नवे	pacān ave
21	इ क्के स	ikkīs	46	छि या ली स	chiyālī s	71	इ क ह तर	ikhatta r	96	छि या नवे	chiyān ave
22	बा ई स	bāīs	47	सैं ता ली स	saintālī s	72	बह तर	behatt ar	97	स ता नवे	sattān ave
23	ते ई स	teīs	48	अड़ ता ली स	aṛtālīs	73	ति ह तर	tihatta r	98	अ ड्डा नवे	aṭṭhān ave
24	चौ बी स	caubīs	49	उन चा स	uncās	74	च्ह तर	cauhat tar	99	नि न्या नवे	ninyān ave

Numeral	Hindi	Transliteration
100	सौ	sau
200	दो सौ	do sau
300	तीन सौ	tīn sau
1000	हज़ार	hazār
2000	दो हज़ार	do hazār

3000	तीन हज़ार	tīn hazār
1,00,000	लाख	lākh
1,00,00,000	करोड़	karor
1,00,00,00,000	अरब	arab
1,00,00,00,00,000	?	kharab
number _____ (<i>train, bus, etc.</i>)	नंबर _____ ट्रेन, बस, ...	nambar _____ tren, bas, ...
1 half	आधा	ādhā
less	कम/थोड़ा	kam/thorā
more	अधिक/ज्यादा	adhiḱ/jyāda

Time

English	Hindi	Transliteration
now	अब, अभी	ab, abhī
later	बाद में, फिर	bād me, phir
before	पहले	pehle
morning	सुबह, सवेरा	subeh, savera (early morn.)
afternoon	दोपहर	dopehar
evening	शाम	shām
night	रात	rāt

Clock time

English	Hindi	Transliteration
one o'clock AM	रात में एक बजे	rāt me ek baje
two o'clock AM	रात में दो बजे	rāt me do baje
noon	दोपहर	dopehar
one o'clock PM	दोपहर एक बजे	dopehar ek baje
two o'clock PM	दोपहर दो बजे	dopehar do baje

midnight	आधी रात	ādhī rāt
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Duration

English	Hindi	Transliteration
minute	मिनट	mināṭ
hour	घंटा	ghaṇṭa
day	दिन	din
week	हफ़्ता	hafta
month	महीना	mahīna
year	साल	sāl

Days

English	Hindi	Transliteration
Today	आज	āj
Yesterday/Tomorrow (depends on context/tense)	कल	... kal
Day after tomorrow/day before yesterday	परसों	parso
Week	हफ़्ता	hafta
This week	इस हफ़्ते	is hafte
Last week	पिछले हफ़्ते	pichle hafte
Next week	अगले हफ़्ते	agle hafte
Two weeks	दो हफ़्ते	do hafte
Month	महीना	mahīna

The Hindi days of the week are each named after a planet and correspond to the Western days of the week, i.e. Sunday = Ravivār (the Sun's day [lit. time or period]). Thursday (Thor's day) = Guruvār (Jupiter's day), Saturday/Saturn's day = Śani's (Saturn's day), etc. The ending "-वार" (-vār), meaning *day, time, or period* is often dropped colloquially.

Day	Hindi	Transliteration
Sunday	इतवार/रविवार	itvār, ravivār (Sun)
Monday	सोमवार	somvār (Moon)
Tuesday	मंगलवार	mangalvār (Mars)
Wednesday	बुधवार	budhvār (Mercury)
Thursday	गुरुवार/बृहस्पतिवार	guruvār/brihaspativār (Jupiter)
Friday	शुक्रवार	śukravār (Venus)
Saturday	शनिवार	śanivār (Saturn)

Months

India has two main calendars in use, though other groups like the Parsis have their own calendar as well. The Western (Gregorian) calendar is used for day to day and business affairs, and the Hindu calendar is used by religious communities.

Gregorian Calendar

Name	Hindi	Transliteration
January	जनवरी	janvarī
February	फ़रवरी	farvarī
March	मार्च	mārc
April	अप्रैल	aprail
May	मई	maī
June	जून	jūn
July	जुलाई	julāī
August	अगस्त	agast
September	सितम्बर	sitambar
October	अक्टूबर	aktūbar
November	नवम्बर	navambar
December	दिसम्बर	disambar

Hindu Calendar

The Hindu Calendar (विक्रम संवत् *Vikram saṃvat*) is named after a legendary king of Ujjain, who is supposed to have founded the Vikramaditya (विक्रमादित्य) era c. 56 BCE. The year 57 BCE was the first year of this (संवत् *saṃvat*) era. Thus, to calculate the current date of the Hindu calendar, add 57 years. Today, the Hindu Calendar is used mainly for religious purposes and calculating festivals. Because it is based on the lunar month, every 30 months an "impure" intercalary leap month is added, during which no ceremonies are performed. The Hindi names are variations of the original Sanskrit ones.

Name	Hindi	Nº of Days	Gregorian Equivalent
Chaitra	चैत्र/चैत	30	(March - April)
Baisākh	बैसाख	31	(April - May)
Jaistha	जेठ	31	(May - June)
Ashār	असाढ़	?	(June-July)
Srāvan	सावन	31	(July-August)
Bhādro	भादों	31	(August-September)
क्वार	30	(September-October)	
Kārttik	कातिक	30	(October-November)
Aghran	अगहन	30	(November-December)
Poūs	पूस	30	(December-January)
Māgh	माघ	30	(January-February)
Phalgun	फागुन	30	(February-March)
Molmās	मलमास	?	?

Writing the time and date

The time is written exactly as in English, that is hours followed by minutes. 12:45am will thus be दोपहर के 12 बजकर पैंतालीस मिनट (*dopehar ke 12 bajkar paintālīs mināt*), note that बजकर (*bajkar*) would indicate something like "o'clock" in English . मिनट (*mināt*) is a direct translation of

the English word "minute/s."

Colours

Colour	Hindi	Transliteration
colour	रंग	rang
colourful	रंगबिरंगी	rangbirangī
colourless	बेरंग	berang
black	काला	kālā
white	सफ़ेद	safed/shwet
red	लाल	lāl
pink, rosy	गुलाबी	gulābī
orange	नारंगी	nārangī
saffron	केसिरया	kesirayā
yellow	पीला	pīla
green	हरा	harā
blue	नीला	nīlā
turquoise	फ़िरोज़ी	firozī
purple	बैंगनी, ज़ाम्नी	bainganī, jāmnī
brown	भूरा	bhūrā
grey	स्लेटी	sleṭī
golden	सुनहरा	suneharā
silver	चांदी	chāndī (also the metal)
shiny	चमकीला	chamkīlā
deep, dark	गहरा	geharā
pale, light	हल्का	halkā

Transportation

Travel Vocabulary

English	Hindi	Transliteration
Train	ट्रेन, रेलगाड़ी	ṭren, relgārī
Train Station	स्टेशन	sṭeśan
Bus	बस	bas; baṛī
Bus Station	बस का अड्डा	bas ka aḍḍa
Bus Stop	बस स्टाप	bas sṭāp
Bicycle	साइकिल	sāikil
Rickshaw	रिक्शा	rickśa
Auto Rickshaw	आटो	āṭo
Taxi	टैक्सी	ṭaiksī
Car	गाड़ी, कार	gārī, kār
Airplane	हवाई जहाज़	havāi jahāz
Airport	हवाई अड्डा	havāi adda

Bus and Train

How much is a ticket to _____ ?

_____ जाने की टिकट कितने की है? _____ jaane ki ticket kitne ki hai?

One ticket to _____

एक _____ की टिकट दीजिये. Ek _____ ki ticket dijiye.

Where does this train go?

ये ट्रेन किधर जाती है? Yeh train kidhar jaati hai?

Does this train/bus stop in _____?

क्या ये ट्रेन/बस _____ पर रुकती है? Kya yeh train/bus _____ par rukti hai?

When does the train/bus for _____ leave?

_____ की ट्रेन/बस कब निकलेगी? _____ ki train/bus kab niklegi?

When will this train/bus arrive in _____?

ये ट्रेन/बस _____ कब पहुँचेगी? Yeh train/bus _____ kab pahuchegi?

Directions

How do I get to _____ ?

_____ tak kaise jaoON?

_____ the train station?

रेलवे स्टेशन _____? — railway station

_____ **the bus station?**

बस अड्डे _____? — bas aḍḍa...?

_____ **the airport?**

हवाई अड्डे _____? — havaai aḍḍa...?

_____ **Town square?**

चौक _____? — chowk

_____ **Hotel?**

_____ होटल...? — hotel

Where can I find (some) _____

(कुछ) _____ कहाँ मिलेंगे? — (kuch) ... kidharai? (?)

_____ **hotels?**

होटलें _____ — hotelEIN

_____ **restaurants?**

रेस्ट्रॉ _____? — restRON

_____ **bars?**

शराब खाने...? — sharaab khaNE

_____ **sites to see?**

...dekhne layek jaghain*? (...)

Can you show me on the map?

मुझे नक्शे में दिखा दीजिये — mujhe nakSHE mEIN dikhaa deejiYE

Can you tell me the way to _____?

मुझे _____ का रास्ता बताइए? — — muJHE _____ kaa rasta bataIYE

street

सड़क — saDak

path

रास्ता — raastaa

Turn left.

बायीं तरफ़ मुड़िये — bāyī muDiye

Turn right.

दाहिनी तरफ़ मुड़िये — dāhinī muDiye

right

दाहिना — dāhina

left

बायाँ — bāyā

straight ahead

सीधे — sīdhe

towards the _____

_____ की ओर — _____ kee OR

past the _____

_____ के अगले — _____ ke agle

before the _____

_____ के पिछले — _____ ke piCHHle

Watch for the _____.

_____ देखो — _____ dekho

intersection

चौराहा — chOWraahaa

north

उत्तर — uttar

south

दक्षिण — dakshin

east

पूर्व — pūrv

west

पश्चिम — paścim

uphill

चढ़ाई — chaDHai

Taxi

Taxi!

टैक्सी — taiksi

Take me to _____, please

_____ जाना है — _____ jaanaa hAI

How much does it cost to get to _____?

_____ जाने को कितना लगता है? — _____ jaane ko kitnaa lagtaa hAI

Lodging

Do you have any rooms available?

Kamra Kirayi pe milega? (...)

How much is a room for one person/two people?

Ek/Do admi ka kitna lagega? (...)

Does the room come with...

Room mein ---- hain kya? (...)

...bedsheets?

...bedsheets? (*chaddar hai?*)

...a bathroom?

...ek bathroom? (*snaanaghara*)

...a telephone?

...ek telephone? (*teliphone*)

...a TV?

...a TV? (*teevee*)

May I see the room first?

May I see the room first? (*pehle, kamra dekh lun?*)

Do you have anything quieter?

Do you have anything quieter? (*ap kai pas aur chupchap/shA.nta/sthira he?*)

...bigger?

...bigger? (*Aur Barrha*)

...cleaner?

...cleaner? (*Aur Saaf*)

...cheaper?

...cheaper? (*Aur Susta*)

OK, I'll take it.

OK, I'll take it. (*Theek hai, laileinge*)

I will stay for _____ night(s).

I will stay for _____ night(s). (*_____raath rahengei*)

Can you suggest another hotel?

Can you suggest another hotel? (*Aur koi hotel batadijeeai*)

Do you have a safe?

Do you have a safe? (*surakShita sthAna hoga?*)

...lockers?

...lockers? (*sharAna sthAna*)

Is breakfast/supper included?

Is breakfast/supper included? (*jalapAna/raathka bhojana-byAlu dhArana he?*)

What time is breakfast/supper?

What time is breakfast/supper? (*kaleva/byAlu kis samaya he?*)

Please clean my room.

Please clean my room. (*kamra saaf kurlo.*)

Can you wake me at _____? | Can you wake me at _____? (_____time pe jugana)

I want to check out.

I want to check out. (*mainai nikalna he*)

Money

Do you accept American/Australian/Canadian dollars?

Do you accept American/Australian/Canadian dollars? (*American/australian/canadian doelur mAnthai/svlkara karthai he?*)

Do you accept British pounds?

Do you accept British pounds? (*British pound svlkara karthaihe?*)

Do you accept credit cards?

Do you accept credit cards? (*CreditKaard svlkara karthaihe?*)

Can you change money for me?

Can you change money for me? (*rupaya parivartna karthaihe?*)

Where can I get money changed?

Where can I get money changed? (*paisa parivartna kidhar karloo?*)

Can you change a traveler's check for me?

Can you change a traveler's check for me? (*traveler check parivartna kurlaiga?*)

Where can I get a traveler's check changed?

Where can I get a traveler's check changed? (*traveler check kiddhar parivartna karoo?*)

What is the exchange rate?

What is the exchange rate? (*parivartna ka bHaoon kitnae?*)

Where is an automatic teller machine (ATM)?

Where is an automatic teller machine (ATM)? (*AeTeeEmm kiddhare?*)

Eating

A table for one person/two people, (please).

एक/दो लोग/-ओं के लिये जगह चाहिये — *ek/do log/-o ke liye jagah cāhiye*

Can I look at the menu, please?

मेण्यू कर्ड दीजिये — *menyoo kard diijiyeh*

Can I look in the kitchen?

Can I look in the kitchen? (*kya mai kitchen ke andar dekh sakta hoon?*)

Is there a house specialty?

Is there a house specialty? (*iis hotel ka special kya hai?*)

Is there a local specialty?

Is there a local specialty? (*iis jaga ka special kya hai?*)

I'm a vegetarian.

मैं शाकाहारी हूँ — *mai śākāhārī*

I don't eat pork.

मैं सुअर का मांस नहीं खाता/-ती — *mai suar ka māns nahī khāta/-ī*

I don't eat beef.

मैं गाय का मांस नहीं खाता/-ती — *mai gāy (gā'ī) māns nahī khāta*

I only eat kosher/halal food.

मैं सिर्फ़ कोशर/हलाल खाना खाता — *mai sirf kośar/halāl khāna khāta (?)*

Can you make it "lite", please? (less oil/butter/lard)

Can you make it "lite", please? (*kum tail mey mil sakta hai?*)

fixed-price meal

एक दाम का खाना — ek dām ka khāna (?)

à la carte

आ-ला कार्ट — ā-lā kārṭ

breakfast

नाश्ता — jalapAna

lunch

दोपहर का खाना — dopehar ka khāna; sa-pehar ka khāna

tea (meal)

शाम का खाना — sa.ndhya ka khāna

dinner

रात का खाना — rāt ka khāna

I want _____.

मैं _____ चाहिये — mujhe _____ cāhiye

I want a dish containing _____.

मैं _____ का खाना चाहिये — — mujhe _____ ka khāna cāhiye (?)

meat

मांस — māns

chicken

मुर्गा — chi.nganA, murgi

beef

गाय का मांस — gāy ka māns

fish

मछली — machlī

lamb

भेड़ का मांस — bher ka māns/mutton

cheese

पनीर — panīr, chlja

eggs

अंडा — anḍa

lentils

दाल — dāl

(fresh) vegetables

(ताज़ा) सब्ज़ी — tarakAri, bhAji

(fresh) fruits

(ताज़ा) फल — pHal

bread

रोटी, नान, पराँठा... — roṭī, parāṭha...

rice

चावल — cāval

sweetmeats

लड्डू — laḍḍū

samosa : समोसा — samosa

spice(s)

मसाला — mirchi

chutney

चटनी — caṭnī

curry

सालन, कढ़ी — sālan, kaṛhī (< Tamil கறி)

ghee (clarified butter)

घी — ghī

May I have a glass/cup/bottle of _____?

मेरे लिये एक ग्लास/प्याला/बोतल _____ लाना — میرے لئے mere liye ek glās/pyāla/

boṭal _____ lāna

coffee

काफी — kāfī

teaचाय — cāy (i.e. *chai*)**juice**

रस — ras

water

पानी, जल — pānī, jal

carbonated water

सोडा — soḍa

milk

दूध — dūdh

lassi (yoghurt drink)

लस्सी — lassī

sweet, salty, mango (lassi)

मीठा, नमकी, आम — mīṭha, namakī, ām

cool drink (Indian Eng. 'soda, cola, etc.')

ठंडी/सौफ्ट ड्रिंक — ṭhandī/sauṭṭ drink

soft drink (attn- in S. Asia this means a sherbet drink, not cola!)

शरबत — śarbat

alcohol

शराब — sharāb

beer

बियर — biyar

red/white wine

(लाल/साफ़ेद) मिदरा, वाइन — — madira, vāin

Whisky

ह्विस्की, स्काच — hviskī/wiskī, skāc

May I have some _____?

May I have some _____? (*muje kuch _____ milega*)

salt

नमक — namak

black pepper

काली मिर्च — kālī mirc

chile

मिर्च — mirc

butter

मक्खन — makkhan

Excuse me, waiter? (getting attention of server)

बैरा!, वेटर! — baira!, veṭar!

I'm finished.

मैं ख़तम है — mai khatam hai (?)

It was delicious.

बढ़िया — بُرّھیا — barhiya

Please clear the plates.

प्लेटें लीजिये — plete lījiye

The check, please.

बिल/चेक लाइये — bil/cek lāiye

Bars

Do you serve alcohol?

Do you serve alcohol? Recommended: **Can I get alcohol?** (*Sharab milega*)

Is there table service?

Is there table service? (*kya table service mil sakti hai*)

A beer/two beers, please.

A beer/two beers, please. (*kripaya ek beer/do beer de*)

A glass of red/white wine, please. एक गिलास लाल/सफ़ेद वाइन (ek glass lal/safed wine)

A bottle, please.

A bottle, please. (*ek bottle dena*)

_____ (**hard liquor**) and _____ (**mixer**), please.

_____ and _____, please. (...)

whiskey

whiskey (*whiskey/daru*)

vodka

vodka (...)

rum

rum (...)

water

पानी (*paani*)

club soda

club soda (*soda*)

tonic water

tonic water (...)

orange juice

orange juice (...)

Coke (soda)

कोक (*kok*)

Do you have any bar snacks?

Do you have any bar snacks? (*kuch khane ke liye hai*)

One more, please.

One more, please. (*ek aur*)

Another round, please.

Another round, please. (*ek aur round milega*)

When is closing time?

When is closing time? (*kab tak khula hai (what time is the bar open till)/ bar band kab hota hai* When does the bar close?)

Shopping

Do you have this in my size?

Do you have this in my size? (...) mere saiz ka milegaa?

How much is this?

How much is this? (...) iska kitna hoga?

That's too expensive.

That's too expensive. (...) bahut mehnga hai

Would you take _____?

Would you take _____? (...) kya aap _____ lena chahege?

expensive

महंगा mehnga

cheap

सस्ता *sastā*

I can't afford it.

I can't afford it. (...) main nahi le sakta

I don't want it.

I don't want it. (...) mujhe nahi chahiye

You're cheating me.

You're cheating me. (...) tu mujhe fassa rahe hoo

I'm not interested.

I'm not interested. (...) mujhe shauk nahi hai

OK, I'll take it.

OK, I'll take it. (...) theek hai, main le letā hoon

Can I have a bag?

Can I have a bag? (...) kyā āp mujhe thaili dege

Do you ship (overseas)?

Do you ship (overseas)? (...) parcel kar sakte hoo

I need...

मुझे ...चाहिये — mujhe ... cāhiye

...toothpaste.

(दँत) मंजन... — (dat) manjan

...a toothbrush.

टूथ ब्रश... — tūth bras

...tampons.

टैम्पोन... — ṭaimpon

...soap.

साबुन... — sābun

...shampoo.

शैंपू... — śaimpū

...pain reliever. (e.g., aspirin or ibuprofen)

दर्द की दवा/"ऐस्पिरिन"... — dard kī dawā

...cold medicine.

खाँसी की दवा... — khāsī kī dawā

...stomach medicine.

दस्तावर... — pet ki dawa / dastāvar

...a razor.

रेज़र/उस्तरा... — rezar, ustara

...an umbrella.

छाता... — chātā

...sunblock lotion.

...sunblock lotion. (...)

...a postcard.

पोस्ट कार्ड... — poṣṭ kārḍ

...postage stamp.

डाक शुल्क/महसूल... — ḍāk tikaṭ/sṭaimp

...batteries.

बैट्री... — baiṭrī

...writing paper.

कागज़... — kāgaz

...a pen.

कलम... — kalam

...a pencil

पेन्सिल... — pensil

...an English-language book.

अंग्रेज़ी की किताब... — angrezī kī kitāb/poṭhl

... an English-language magazine.

अंग्रेज़ी की पत्रिका... — angrezī ka/kī patrika/risālah/maigazīn

...an English-language newspaper.

अंग्रेज़ी का अख़बार... — angrezī kā akhbār; ...an English-Hindi dictionary. :

अंग्रेज़ी-हिन्दी कोश... — angrezī-hindī koś

Driving

I want to rent a car.

मुझे कार किराया चाहिये — mujhe kār kirāya par cāhiye

Can I get insurance?

मुझे बीमा का कार सकता है? — mera insurance ho sakta (-ī) hai? (?)

petrol shed

पेट्रोल पंप — peṭrol pamp

petrol

पेट्रोल — peṭrol

diesel

डीज़ल — ḍīzal

Note: Indian Traffic Signs are much like those in Europe. Words are written in English and sometimes the regional language.

Problems

Leave me alone.

(mujhe akela chhod do)

Don't touch me!

मुझे मत छूओ । (*mujhe chunā mat / mujhe mat chuo*)

I'll call the police.

I'll call the police. पोलीस को बुलाता हूं । (*main police ko bulaaunga*)

Police!

पोलीस ! पोलीस ! (*police ! police !*)

Stop! Thief!

रुको ! चोर ! (*rukho! chor!*)

I need your help.

मुझे आपकी सहायता चाहिये । (*mujhe āpki sahayta/madad chahie*)

It's an emergency.

यह एक मुसिबत है । (*yeh ek musibat hai*)

I'm lost.

मैं रास्ता भूल गया । (*main rasta bhul gaya*)

I lost my bag.

मेरा बैग गुम हो गया । (*mera bag alage ho gaya*)

I lost my wallet.

मेरा पर्स गुम हो गया । (*mera purse ghoom ho gaya*)

I'm sick.

मेरी तबियत ठीक नहीं है । (*meri tabhiyet tikh nai hei*)

I've been injured.

मुझे चोट लगी है । (*mujhe chot lagi hai*)

I need a doctor.

मुझे डॉक्टर चाहिये । (*mujhe doctor chahie*)

Can I use your phone?

क्या मैं फ़ोन कर सकता हूं ? (*kya main phone kar sakta hoon ?*)

Authority

I haven't done anything wrong.

I haven't done anything wrong. (.*maine kuch galat nahi kiya..*)

It was a misunderstanding.

It was a misunderstanding. (.*Woh ek bhool thi..*)

Where are you taking me?

Where are you taking me? (.*Aap mujhe kahan le ja rahe hain?..*)

Am I under arrest?

Am I under arrest? (.*Kya mein giraftaar ho raha hoon?..*)

I am an American/Australian/British/Canadian citizen.

I am an American/Australian/British/Canadian citizen. (.*Mein America/Australia/Britain/Canada ka nagrik hoon..*)

I want to talk to the American/Australian/British/Canadian embassy/consulate.

I need to talk to the American/Australian/British/Canadian embassy/consulate. (.Mujhe America/ Australia/Britain/Canada ke rajdoot se sampark karna hai..)

I want to talk to a lawyer.

I want to talk to a lawyer. (.Mujhe apne vakil se baat karni hai..)

Can I just pay a fine now?

Can I just pay a fine now? (.Kya mein jurmaana abhi de sakta hoon?..)